

## **Project Release Manager**

### **Position Summary**

The Project Release Manager is responsible for planning, coordinating, governing, and executing the release of project deliverables into production or operational environments. The role ensures that releases are delivered on time, meet quality standards, minimize business disruption, and align with organizational objectives.

Working across project teams, business stakeholders, technical teams, and vendors, the Project Release Manager provides leadership throughout the release lifecycle, from planning and readiness assessments through deployment and post-release review.

### **Project:** Automated Parcel Machines (APMs) Network Expansion

In global logistics and shipping infrastructure, APMs stands for Automated Parcel Machines (commonly known as Parcel Lockers). Australia Post has a long-running project to continuously expand, modernise, and integrate its automated parcel locker network.

- The Objective: To scale up out-of-home (OOH) delivery solutions, reducing last-mile carbon footprints and lowering the cost of missed deliveries.
- Key Features: Giving consumers 24/7 access to secure locker facilities via the AusPost App and enabling e-commerce platforms to embed locker drop-off locations directly into online store checkouts using Australia Post Developer APIs.

**Reason for role:** A late resourcing gap was discovered in the AMS delivery plan once it was confirmed that Technical Delivery Leads no longer assist with release management for anything related to applications. The AMS project has a significant application profile and urgently needs a skilled and experienced Technical Project Manager to close this gap

### **Key Responsibilities**

#### **Release Planning & Coordination**

- Develop and maintain release plans, schedules, and deployment timelines.
- Develop detailed release runbooks and coordinate release activities across multiple projects, teams, and workstreams.
- Facilitate release planning meetings and establish release governance processes.
- Ensure dependencies, milestones, risks, and resource requirements are identified and managed.
- Align release schedules with business priorities and operational constraints.

#### **Release Governance**

- Establish and enforce release management standards, processes, and controls aligned to Auspost Change Advisory Board (CAB).
- Lead release readiness assessments and approval processes.
- Ensure compliance with organizational policies, security requirements, and change management procedures.
- Maintain release calendars and communicate upcoming releases to stakeholders.

#### **Stakeholder Management**

- Act as the primary point of contact for release-related activities.

- Collaborate with project managers, product owners, business leaders, technical teams, and external vendors.
- Provide regular status updates, reporting, and executive communications.
- Manage stakeholder expectations and facilitate decision-making when release issues arise.

#### **Risk & Issue Management**

- Identify release risks and develop mitigation strategies.
- Manage release-related issues, escalations, and decisions.
- Coordinate contingency planning and rollback strategies where required.
- Ensure business continuity and minimize production impact during deployments.

#### **Quality & Readiness Assurance**

- Verify that all testing, validation, and approval requirements are completed before release.
- Ensure deployment checklists and operational readiness requirements are met.
- Coordinate user acceptance testing (UAT), training, and business readiness activities where applicable.
- Support transition activities into business-as-usual operations.

#### **Deployment & Post-Release Support**

- Coordinate deployment activities and release execution.
- Monitor release outcomes and resolve post-deployment issues.
- Conduct post-implementation reviews and lessons learned sessions.
- Drive continuous improvement of release management processes and practices.

#### **Key Accountabilities**

- Successful delivery of releases according to agreed scope, schedule, and quality expectations.
- Effective alignment with Auspost governance and Change Advisory Board (CAB) processes.
- Minimal disruption to business operations during deployments.
- Accurate release reporting and stakeholder communication.
- Continuous improvement of release management capability and maturity.

#### **Skills & Experience**

##### **Essential**

- 5+ years of experience in project delivery, release management, change management, or technology operations.
- Demonstrated experience managing complex project and technology releases.
- Strong understanding of project management and delivery methodologies (Agile, Waterfall, Hybrid).
- Experience coordinating cross-functional teams and managing competing priorities.
- Strong risk management and issue resolution capabilities.
- Excellent stakeholder engagement and communication skills.
- Experience with release management, change management, and deployment processes.

##### **Desirable**

- Experience within enterprise technology, digital transformation, infrastructure, or application delivery environments.
- Familiarity with IT Service Management (ITSM) practices.
- Experience with Jira, ServiceNow, Microsoft Project, or similar tools.

- Knowledge of DevOps, CI/CD, and modern software delivery practices.
- Experience managing vendor-delivered solutions and third-party dependencies.

**Qualifications****Required**

- Bachelor's degree in Information Technology, Business, Project Management, Engineering, or related discipline.

**Preferred**

- PRINCE2, PMP, or PMBoK certification.
- ITIL Foundation or higher certification.
- Agile certifications (Scrum Master, SAFe, AgilePM, or equivalent).
- Change Management certification (Prosci or equivalent).